AMAZON CONNECT

OVERVIEW

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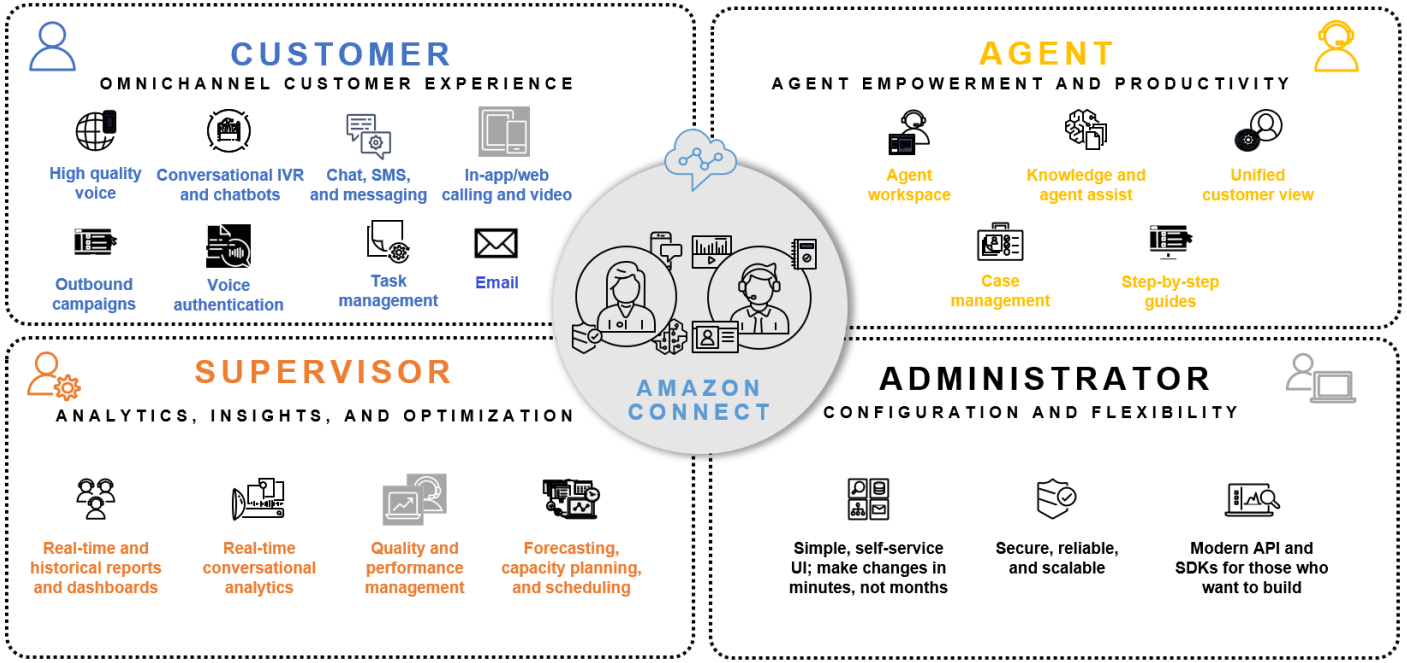
WHAT IS AMAZON CONNECT?

- Amazon Connect is a cloud-based contact center service provided by Amazon Web Services
- It lets businesses:
  - Handle phone calls, chats, and tasks
  - Build customer support systems
  - Automate interactions with AI
- Think of it as a call center in the cloud, no hardware required!
- Like with most AWS products, it scales instantly and offers 'pay-as-you-go' pricing
- Connect is an open platform, meaning it easily connects with existing CRM services (like Salesforce) and with other machine learning services

AMAZON CONNECT USERS

- Customers reach out to your contact center because they need assistance
- Agents are responsible for helping customers solve general problems
- Managers/supervisors monitor their team's metrics and onboard new agents
- Administrators handle the entire Amazon Connect configuration



ARCHITECTURE

- The key architectural layers of Amazon Connect:
  - Entry Layer (Telephony & Channels) - this is where customer interactions begin and a Contact Object is created
    - Includes phone numbers, web/mobile chat widgets, or task APIs
    - The contact object includes details such as the contact ID, channel, attributes, and state
  - Orchestration Layer (Contact Flows) - contact flows are responsible for playing prompts, calling external services, and setting attributes
  - Routing Layer (Queues & Profiles) - once a decision is made, the contact is routed to the appropriate queue for an agent or bot to handle
  - Execution Layer (Agents, Bots, Lambda) - agents use the Amazon Connect Contact Control Panel to receive contacts, stream audio, and display customer data
  - Data & Analytics Layer – Amazon Connect itself is stateless during execution, but integrates with data services like DynamoDB, S3, or RDS to store related data

APPINTEGRATIONS

- Amazon AppIntegrations is an AWS service that allows Amazon Connect to integrate with external applications
  - Particularly CRM systems(like Salesforce or ServiceNow) and third-party tools without building everything from scratch
- AppIntegrations lets us use prebuilt connectors to unify data access across multiple systems
  - This reduces the need for custom code connections
- It sits between the Execution layer and the Data Layer and handles authentication and authorization

CONTACT LENS

- Amazon Connect Contact Lens is an AI-powered analytics too that automatically analyzes voice calls and chat conversations
- It extracts transcripts, sentiment (customer mood), and key issues and trends
- It acts as an AI supervisor that reviews every interaction automatically
- Contact Lens can provide both real-time and post-call analytics
- Results are stored in an S3 bucket in the form of transcripts, audio recordings, and analysis results

OUTBOUND CAMPAIGNS

- Outbound Campaigns allows you to proactively contact customers instead of waiting for them to call you
- Examples include:
  - Appointment reminders
  - Payment notifications
  - Marketing calls
  - Customer follow-ups
- Think of it as automated, scalable outbound calling powered by AI and dialing strategies

CASES

- Amazon Connect Cases is a built-in case management system that helps agents track customer issues, manage ongoing interactions, and maintain history across multiple contacts
- It is a system for tracking customer problems from start to resolution
- With cases, conversations are connected, history is preserved, and resolution is faster
- Each individual case represents a single customer issue
- Each case has fields like Case ID, customer name, status, and description
  - We can create custom fields to fit our business needs

PARTICIPANT SERVICE

- Participant Service is a set of APIs in Amazon Connect that allows us to:
  - Send and receive messages in a contact
  - Manage chat participants
  - Build custom chat experiences outside the default UI
- While agents typically use Contact Control Panel, we can use Participant Service if we want a custom website chat widget, a mobile app chat experience, or backend-controlled messaging
- It sits between your frontend chat UI and Amazon Connect's contact system

CUSTOMER PROFILES

- Amazon Connect Customer Profiles is a service that creates a unified view of each customer by aggregating data from multiple sources
- It allows you to:
  - Combine customer data from different systems
  - Resolve duplicate identities
  - Provide agents with a complete customer history
- It acts as a centralized customer data hub for your contact center
- It exists between your external systems and Amazon Connect

Q CONNECT

- Amazon Q Connect is a generative AI assistant built into Amazon Connect that helps agents:
  - Get real-time suggestions
  - Find answers from knowledge bases
  - Automate responses
  - Improve customer interactions
- It is like an AI copilot for contact center agents

DEMO

- Let's get started with Amazon Connect!